BOOK POLITICS

GOVERNMENT OFFICES & ELECTIONS

What the president and each cabinet minister can actually do, the desks they work from, the salaries offices pay, and how the two-week election cycle fills the seats.

UPDATED 2026-10-10

THE CABINET

The president appoints and dismisses up to four ministers — **Economy**, **Foreign**, **Interior** and **Defense** — from the Government tab of the Parliament page or from a citizen's profile page.

- A minister must be a **citizen** of the state.
- A citizen holds **one ministry at a time**: to give someone another portfolio, dismiss them from the first. The president cannot appoint themselves — the presidency already holds those powers.
- A minister who takes another country's citizenship loses the post at once; they and the president are notified.
- Every office — presidency or ministry — is vacated when its holder's account goes **inactive** (15 days away) or is erased. A ban on its own does not cost an office.

Each office holds real power:

OFFICE	POWERS
President	Appoints and dismisses the cabinet. Enacts directly: tax rates, the notary fee, a currency change, a capital move, borders, the immigration policy, every diplomacy act, export bans and war declarations. Shares the interior desk, the foreign affairs desk and the diplomatic-offers desk, and is the only one who can put a region-purchase offer to parliament or withdraw a region-sale offer. Addresses the nation.
Economy minister	The Economy desk: sets the four tax rates and the notary fee at once, posts and removes **government FX orders**, and enacts **new buildings** directly. FX orders and new buildings

OFFICE	POWERS
	belong to this office alone — even the president must put them to a vote. Also enacts export bans.
Foreign minister	The Foreign Affairs desk: proposes, accepts, renews and ends alliances; imposes and lifts embargoes. The Diplomatic offers & trade desk: proposes and ends trade agreements, answers incoming offers or sends them to parliament. Opens and closes the borders directly.
Interior minister	The Interior desk: decides citizenship and work-permit applications, sees every active work permit and can revoke it. Sets the immigration policy directly.
Defense minister	The Defense desk: the state's active wars and the war declarations against it still in voting. Enacts war declarations directly.

The president and the interior minister can also designate the state's Official Gazette.

An official's power also speeds up open votes: their **Yes** on a law their office covers settles the ballot at once (see Parliament & Laws).

THE DESKS

The **Government** tab of the Parliament page shows each office holder the desks of the offices they hold:

- **Cabinet** (president) — who holds each ministry; appoint and dismiss.
- **Interior — Applications** (interior minister and president) — pending citizenship applications and work-permit applications, each with Approve and Reject, and the list of **Active work permits**. Under the Automatic immigration policy there is no permit queue: applications approve on arrival.
- **Economy** (economy minister) — tax rates, the notary fee, government FX orders.
- **Foreign Affairs** (foreign minister and president) — alliances and embargoes.
- **Diplomatic offers & trade** (foreign minister and president) — incoming and outgoing offers and the active trade agreements.
- **Defense** (defense minister) — active wars and incoming declarations.

The Government tab's badge counts what is waiting for an answer.

REVOKING A WORK PERMIT

The president and the interior minister see every active work permit for their country — who holds it, their citizenship and since when — and can **Revoke** any of them. The holder is notified. They keep any job they

have in the country, but cannot work shifts there until they get a new permit or the country's citizenship. (A holder can also give up a permit themselves — see Travel, Permits & Moving Abroad.)

While a state has neither a president nor an interior minister, citizenship and work-permit applications are approved at once — there is nobody to review them.

ADDRESSING THE PEOPLE

- The **president** can **Address the nation** from the country page: one message of **5–200 characters**, delivered to every citizen as a notification. The latest address stays on the country page under "From the president".
- A **party leader** can **Address the party** from the party page: one message of 5–200 characters to every member.
- Each can speak **once every 6 hours**. Accounts that have gone inactive are not sent addresses.

SALARIES

Offices pay daily — minted by the game, never taken from the treasury:

- President: **10 gold per owned region per day**
- Each minister: **5 gold per owned region per day**

A five-region country pays its president 50 gold a day; growing the map literally raises the government's wages.

Under a dictatorship there is a single office: the **Leader** earns **20 gold per owned region per day**, and there are no ministers to pay.

A day's salaries are paid the first time the country's profile is opened that UTC day. A day on which nobody opens it pays nothing, and missed days are not paid later. The profile lists who is paid how much.

UNDER A DICTATORSHIP

A dictatorship has no cabinet: the ministers lose their posts when it begins, and no new ones can be appointed. The Government tab becomes the **Leader's controls**, with every desk — interior, economy, foreign affairs, diplomatic offers and defense — served to the Leader, and every law the Leader signs is a decree in force at once. See Parties & Elections.

THE ELECTION CYCLE

Elections run on a **14-day cycle**, each ballot open for **24 hours**:

- **Parliamentary election** — parties compete for parliament; seats are split by vote share and filled from each party's roster (leader first, then secretaries, then members by join date).
- **Presidential election** — opens **24 hours after** the parliamentary ballot closes; each party holding seats fields one candidate.

Voting requires **3 full days of citizenship** — a last-minute migration wave cannot swing a ballot. The **parliamentary** ballot has no fixed list: any party of the country can be voted for while it is open. The **presidential** candidate list is fixed when that ballot **opens** — one candidate per seat-holding party, the party's pick or else its leader — so party changes made before the polls open still count.

The **Call early parliamentary election** and **Call early presidential election** laws always go to a vote — no office can enact them directly — and run their full 24 hours unless every eligible voter has voted. The full rules are on Parties & Elections.

FOUNDING A PARTY

Any citizen at level 10 or higher can found a party for **50 gold**. Members wear the party's [ABBR] tag before their name — each member can hide it with a switch in Settings — and every party gets a private chat room. The leader manages applications, ranks and the presidential candidacy; see Parties & Elections.

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